

Brazil's Presidential Election Heads to a Run-Off

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Brazil held an election for president on Sunday. No one won more than 50 percent of the votes, so there will be a second round of voting on October 25, called a **run-off**.

Flávio Bolsonaro, a **right-wing** politician, finished first. He beat Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva, the **left-wing** president who is now in office. Bolsonaro did better than many people expected. His father, Jair Bolsonaro, is a former president. He is serving a 27-year prison sentence for leading a failed **coup attempt** after losing the last election. He was not allowed to run again, so his son ran instead.

Lula is 80 years old and wants a fourth term. Bolsonaro is 45. After voting, Lula said the choice was between **democracy** and "barbarism." Bolsonaro said he wanted to "free the Brazilian people."

Voters said the economy, crime and **corruption** were top concerns. Lula said the United States tried to influence the election. On Sunday, the head of Brazil's top electoral court said no evidence of that was found.

Brazil is the largest country in Latin America.

Word Treasure

run-off -- A second round of voting between the top two candidates.

right-wing -- A set of political ideas that is usually more conservative.

left-wing -- A set of political ideas that is usually more progressive.

coup attempt -- An attempt to take over a government by force.

democracy -- A system where people choose their leaders by voting.

corruption -- When people in power act dishonestly to gain money or power.

Break it down

Opening: no winner yet, so a run-off is set

Who the two leading candidates are

What each candidate said

Voters' concerns and the claim about the United States

Brazil's size and importance

Why it matters

Brazil is the biggest country in Latin America, so who its voters choose affects people there and the way countries in the region work together.

Test what you remember

1. When will Brazil's second round of voting be?

- ☐ (A) Next Sunday
- ☐ (B) On Sunday
- ☐ (C) October 25
- ☐ (D) In December

2. Why is there a second round?

- ☐ (A) Too few people voted
- ☐ (B) No one won more than 50 percent of the votes
- ☐ (C) Voting was stopped by rain
- ☐ (D) The president quit

3. Who finished first in the first round?

- ☐ (A) Jair Bolsonaro
- ☐ (B) The court's head
- ☐ (C) Lula da Silva
- ☐ (D) Flávio Bolsonaro

4. How old is Lula?

- ☐ (A) 80
- ☐ (B) 25
- ☐ (C) 27
- ☐ (D) 45

5. What was Jair Bolsonaro sentenced to?

- ☐ (A) Four years in office
- ☐ (B) A fine of 27 dollars
- ☐ (C) 27 years in prison
- ☐ (D) Nothing, he was freed

6. What did the head of Brazil's top electoral court say?

- ☐ (A) No evidence of outside interference was found
- ☐ (B) The vote must be done again
- ☐ (C) The election was cancelled
- ☐ (D) Lula broke the voting rules

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: B 3: D 4: A 5: C 6: A

Questions to think about

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):